

Audio Mixing

Learning Objectives

- Import multiple audio tracks into Audacity
- Adjust volume levels and pan left/right channels
- Mix multiple tracks and export the final audio

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a temple festival where a tabla player, a flute player, and a singer perform together. The sound man adjusts each instrument's volume so they blend nicely. Audio mixing does the same thing digitally—combining different sounds into one balanced track.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open two audio files in Audacity as separate tracks. Use the gain slider on each track to make one louder and the other softer. Play both together and adjust until they sound balanced. Use the pan knob to move one track to the left speaker and the other to the right.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Audio mixing combines multiple tracks into one. Each track has a gain slider for volume control and a pan knob for left-right balance. The mixer toolbar provides overall control. When satisfied, use File > Export > Export as MP3 to save the mixed audio.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Create a short audio mix: record yourself speaking a poem on one track and import a saved instrumental clip on another track. Adjust volumes so the voice is clear over the music. Practice soloing and muting individual tracks. Write which combination sounded best.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Demonstrate your mixed audio to the class. Answer: What is the difference between gain and pan? When would you use the mute button during mixing?